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# I kept forgetting to drink water in the heat, so I designed and built HeatBud






Philip Nosike · 8 min read

01

# The problem with weather apps

Every weather app I opened gave me a number. 34°. 36°. Partly cloudy. But a number doesn't tell you what to do with it. Is it safe to go out at 1 PM? Should I move that errand to the evening? How much water do I actually need today?

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# A weather number is data. What people need in the heat is a decision.

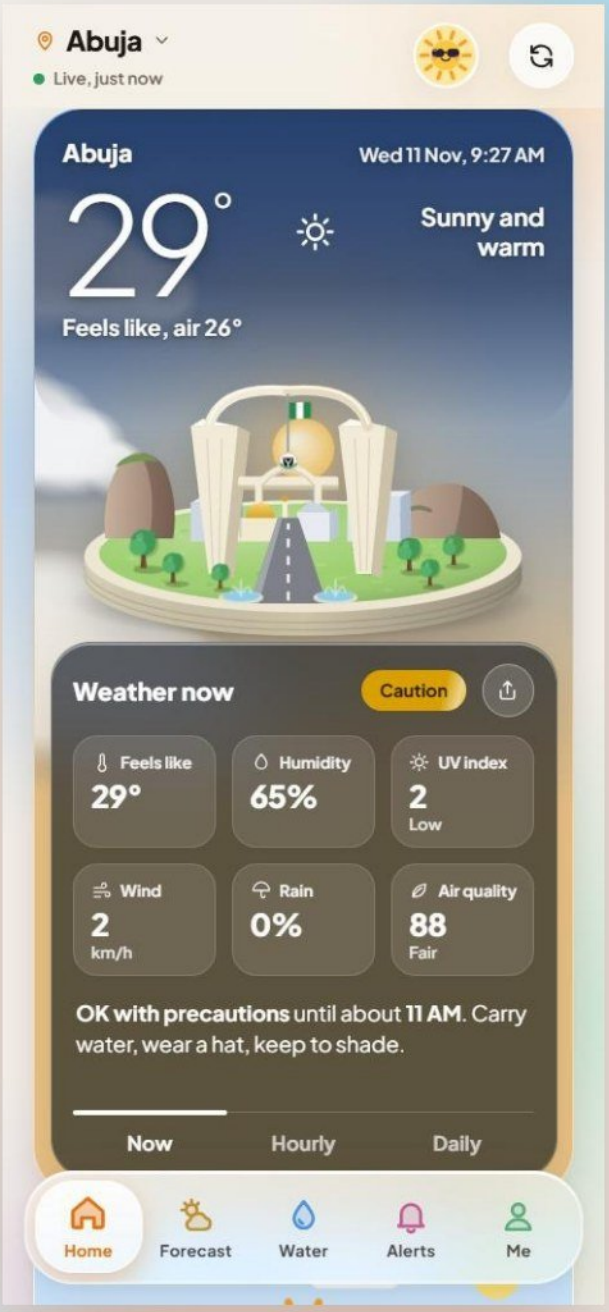
# So I designed a buddy, not a dashboard

1. Lead with how hot it feels, not the air temperature, because humidity changes everything.

2. Always say what to do next, in one plain sentence.

3. Make it feel like it was made here: Abuja on screen, Nigerian time, everyday English.

4. Keep it friendly. Heat is serious, but fear doesn't make people open an app twice.

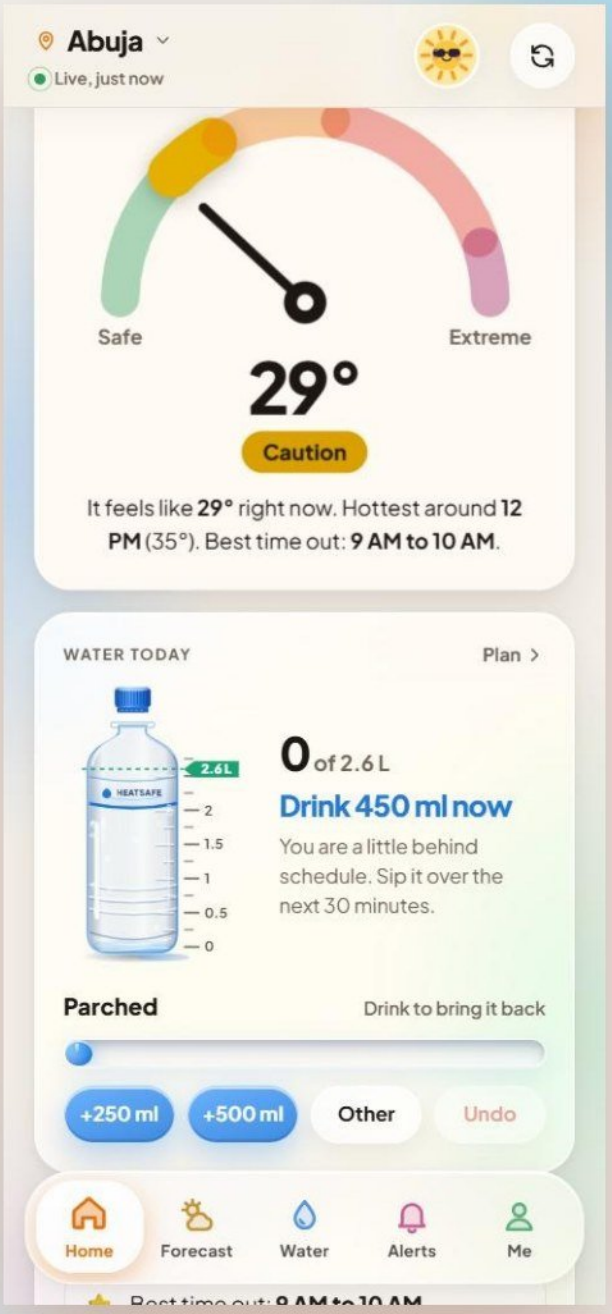



## Home: how hot it feels, the risk level, and one sentence telling you what to do.

02

# The water bottle took three tries

My first idea filled the whole Water page like a glass. It looked fun in a mockup. In use, it took over the screen and buried everything else. So I moved water tracking onto Home as a real bottle with a side scale, the way you'd check one on your desk.




**The bottle tells you how far behind you are and how much to drink now.**

03

# The part I didn’t expect: safety

“Drink more water” sounds like harmless advice. It isn’t for everyone. People with heart, kidney or liver conditions, or on water pills, can be harmed by drinking too much. So HeatBud asks.

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# Designing for health means designing for the person the feature could hurt, not just the person it helps.

READ THE FULL STORY

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